

Paint the town red

Nightlife is a green market — no account-to-account provider owns it yet. This is the case for being the one that does: bars, clubs, festivals and events as a new market for Pay by Bank.

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THE CASE IN ONE LINE

A **EUR 100.6 billion** high-risk card category with no dedicated account-to-account provider yet — entered through a focused, low-cost summer pilot in Denmark and the UK that produces a lighthouse case with real numbers.

The case.

A large market, a documented cost problem, and an open position.

Nightlife is one of Europe's largest consumer payment categories — the European pubs, bars and coffee shops sector alone turns over EUR 100.6 billion a year — and it sits in a high-risk card category. Venues pay 3.5–7% all-in on card acquiring, hold rolling reserves of 5–15% of gross volume, and a single disputed transaction costs about 3.9 times its face value once fees, lost goods, reserves and admin are counted (LexisNexis). The pressure is rising: first-party fraud more than doubled between 2023 and 2024, and Visa's monitoring thresholds tightened again in April 2026.

Pay by Bank removes the most expensive part of that cost by design. Account-to-account payments do not run through the card schemes, so the scheme chargeback and the rolling reserve disappear, and the rail runs at a fraud rate of 0.013% against 0.045% for the wider industry (H1 2025, Open Banking Limited). The fee is fixed, not percentage-based — at a normal Danish round of DKK 150 it works out around 2%, and the saving grows with every krone the guest spends. The rail underneath is proven at national scale: UK open banking processed 31 million payments in March 2025 alone, up 70% year on year.

And the position is open. Account-to-account providers are established in restaurants, hotels and ticketing — but none has built a dedicated position in nightlife with named customer cases. That is the green market. Aryze runs on Mastercard Open Banking across 19 European markets and around 2,900 banks, which makes it more credible than the early-stage providers nearby. The conclusion is deliberately modest: a focused, low-cost summer pilot in Denmark and the UK that produces a lighthouse case with real numbers, with any larger investment gated on that case.

In six numbers.

THE MARKET

**EUR
100.6bn**

The European pubs, bars and coffee shops sector — a high-volume, high-risk category with no dedicated account-to-account provider yet.

THE PAIN

**3.9x
face
value**

What a single disputed card transaction costs a European merchant once fees, lost goods, reserves and admin are counted (LexisNexis).

THE FRAUD GAP

**0.013% ~ 2%
vs
0.045% at a round**

Account-to-account fraud against the wider payment industry (H1 2025, Open Banking Limited) — roughly 3.5 times lower, and falling while industry fraud rises.

THE PRICE POINT

The fixed fee at a DKK 150 round — against 3.5-7% all-in on high-risk card acquiring, with no rolling reserve held back.

THE VOLUME

**80-
100m**

Estimated addressable payment transactions a year in UK nightlife and events alone — and revenue on the rail is a straight function of transaction count.

THE MOVE

**Summer
pilot**

Denmark and the UK, low cost, live transactions — the lighthouse case with real numbers that any larger investment is gated on.

How we enter.

The motion is direct and deliberately small before it is big.

POSITIONING

Risk off, lights on

The pitch leads on chargeback elimination and Mastercard-grade reliability, with price as the supporting point — it already beats cards at realistic ticket sizes. Aryze sits alongside the venue's existing card setup, not instead of it.

THE MOTION

Owner-led, then chains

Direct, owner-led outreach accelerated by the team's industry network. Execution starts in Denmark and rolls to the UK and selected EU markets; first targets are premium, owner-led venues where decisions are fast, then venue groups and chains for scale. Festivals are a 2027 motion — the 2026 season is already contracted.

DELIBERATELY OUT

Clear edges

Adult and strip-club businesses are excluded from all sizing and outreach. And the case is kept separate from the core Pay by Bank profile (iGaming, casino, betting) on purpose — it documents how we assess and enter a new high-risk market, end to end.

What the board was asked.

Three decisions — and one line that frames them.

ASK 1

Approve the pilot

A focused, low-cost commercial pilot in Denmark and the UK over the summer, with its resourcing — a parallel exploration alongside iGaming, not a move away from it.

ASK 2

Confirm the pricing

The fixed fee and the mainstream tier the pilot quotes, set at internal sign-off before the first venue conversation.

ASK 3

Gate the scaling

Further investment — including the platform and chain motion — depends on the pilot producing a credible lighthouse case with real numbers.

The recommendation in the memo: say yes to the pilot, not yes to the vertical. The pilot is what earns the larger decision.

Read the case.

The decision, and the full analysis behind it.

DECISION · 1 PAGE

Board memo

The go / no-go: approve a focused summer pilot in Denmark and the UK, confirm pricing, and tie further scaling to a lighthouse case.

[Open the memo →](#)

FULL CASE

Commercial report

The complete analysis: market, cost of the card category, transaction opportunity, economics, geography and go-to-market — with figures and sources.

[Open the report →](#)